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LEAD REPORT / REGIONAL DIPLOMACY / TRADE

Pakistan Presses SCO for Regional Investment and Payment Reform

At the Dushanbe gathering, Islamabad put connectivity, technology and local-currency settlement at the centre of regional cooperation.

On Tuesday, 20 October, Deputy Prime Minister and Foreign Minister Ishaq Dar called for targeted investment in energy, transport and other productive sectors at the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation Council of Heads of Government meeting in Dushanbe, Tajikistan. His address treated regional integration as a practical task involving roads, energy networks, investment financing and cross-border commerce, rather than a declaration of political intent.

Dar presented agriculture, mining and minerals, and information technology as sectors in which SCO economies could build joint ventures. He described the China–Pakistan Economic Corridor as a possible route for other SCO partners to join wider regional economic activity. His remarks also identified digital transformation, artificial intelligence and international information security as areas for cooperation.

AT A GLANCE

01 REGIONAL INVESTMENT

Pakistan urged an SCO bank, development funds and more national-currency settlement.

02 FISCAL REFORM

President Zardari discussed revenue mobilisation and IMF programmes with Jihad Azour.

03 COUNTERTERRORISM DEBATE

Rana Sanaullah offered talks as governor's rule in KP remained contested.

04 ASIA-PACIFIC ECONOMY

APEC ministers opened discussions on fiscal resilience and digital infrastructure in Hong Kong.

05 CLIMATE RISK

Reuters published new research describing expanding, long-lasting extreme-heat events.

BACKGROUND / ANALYSIS

The SCO links Eurasian economies with differing commercial interests; proposed banking and local-currency arrangements depend on actual funding, settlement capacity and trade demand.

REVISION POINTS

01 Dushanbe hosted the SCO Council of Heads of Government on 20 October. 02 Dar urged development-finance mechanisms and local-currency trade. 03 Energy, mining and information technology were priority areas.

CSS ANGLE International Relations / regional organisations and economic connectivity **SOURCES** Radio Pakistan · Radio Pakistan

01 Pakistan

Policy, economic governance, diplomacy and domestic institutions

SBP POLICY RATE	KSE-100 CLOSE
11.50%	165,151.64
Last monetary-policy decision: 14 Sep 2026 · SBP	20 Oct 2026, 15:50 PKT · PSX

01 / ECONOMY / PUBLIC FINANCE

Zardari Meets IMF Official on Revenue and Reform Priorities

Revenue documentation, fiscal discipline and institution-building were central to the Islamabad discussion.

On Tuesday, 20 October, President Asif Ali Zardari met Jihad Azour, director of the International Monetary Fund's Middle East and Central Asia Department, in Islamabad. According to the official account, the president highlighted tax documentation, digitised collection, action against evasion and public-sector reform as government priorities.

The president linked revenue measures to fiscal sustainability, reform of the energy sector, privatisation and the maintenance of social protection. He also referred to the staff-level agreement under the fourth review of the Extended Fund Facility and third review of the Resilience and Sustainability Facility. That agreement had been reached earlier in October; the qualifying development on Tuesday was the new meeting and the positions expressed during it.

In figures reported by the presidency, Pakistan's economy reached $452.1 billion in FY2025–26 and recorded real GDP growth of 3.7%, compared with 3.2% in FY2024–25. These were figures stated by the president at the meeting, rather than independently established estimates in the meeting account. Azour stressed the need to sustain macroeconomic discipline and reforms.

BACKGROUND

The IMF programme links macroeconomic stabilisation with fiscal and structural commitments. A staff-level agreement does not, by itself, constitute a new IMF disbursement or an Executive Board approval.

ANALYSIS

The revenue agenda has two linked tests: whether digital systems broaden the tax base and whether expenditure and energy-sector reforms prevent fresh pressures on the budget. Headline growth figures do not alone measure distribution, productivity or private investment.

REVISION POINTS

1. President Zardari met IMF department director Jihad Azour in Islamabad.
2. The EFF and RSF were the two facilities mentioned in the exchange.
3. GDP figures of $452.1bn and 3.7% growth were cited by the presidency for FY2025–26.

CSS ANGLE Pakistan Affairs / fiscal capacity and economic governance **SOURCES** Radio Pakistan

02 / SECURITY / FEDERALISM

Senate Debate Reopens Path to Counterterrorism Talks

The government expressed readiness for party-wide engagement while the dispute over emergency rule in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa continued.

On Tuesday, 20 October, Adviser to the Prime Minister on Political Affairs Rana Sanaullah told the Senate that the federal government was prepared to invite political parties to develop a consensus on counterterrorism. He urged opposition parties to put aside other demands for that purpose, according to Dawn's account of the proceedings.

The statement came against the background of the federal decision on 11 October to impose emergency and governor's rule in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa. The government had cited counterterrorism concerns and what it characterised as disengagement by the former provincial administration. Opposition figures disputed the measure and argued that it displaced an elected provincial mandate.

Constitutional petitions challenging the emergency proclamation were also before the Peshawar High Court. The legal questions concern the constitutional conditions for emergency powers and the relationship between federal security decisions and provincial autonomy. The 20 October Senate remarks were an invitation to political dialogue, not evidence that a consensus, agreement or settlement had already been reached.

BACKGROUND

The Khyber Pakhtunkhwa proclamation was issued on 11 October under constitutional emergency provisions. Litigation and political objection to the measure are distinct from the federal government's arguments about security necessity.

ANALYSIS

A negotiated security policy must address operational coordination without making public trust or constitutional accountability optional. The dispute places the federal government's stated security objectives alongside opposition arguments about representative government and provincial powers.

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REVISION POINTS

1. Rana Sanaullah made the reported consensus offer in the Senate on 20 October.
2. The KP governor's-rule proclamation dated from 11 October.
3. The government and opposition articulated different claims about security and provincial democratic legitimacy.

CSS ANGLE Current Affairs / federalism, emergency powers and internal security **SOURCES** Dawn · Dawn

03 / FOREIGN POLICY / INDIAN OCEAN

Maldivian President Begins Three-Day State Visit to Pakistan

Maritime security, commerce and climate cooperation form part of the visit's announced agenda.

On Tuesday, 20 October, Maldivian President Mohamed Muizzu arrived in Islamabad for a three-day state visit at the invitation of Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif. The official report stated that First Lady Sajidha Mohamed and a delegation of ministers and senior officials accompanied him.

Maritime Affairs Minister Muhammad Junaid Anwar and Minister of State Wajiha Qamar received the delegation at the airport. Meetings with President Asif Ali Zardari and Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif were planned, including restricted and delegation-level discussions.

BACKGROUND

Pakistan and the Maldives are Indian Ocean states with overlapping interests in maritime connections, ocean governance and climate-related risks. The visit opens political space for practical cooperation in those fields.

ANALYSIS

The policy significance lies less in the ceremonial protocol than in whether follow-

The announced agenda spans trade, investment, education, healthcare, tourism, agriculture, defence, maritime security and climate change. The arrival and agenda are confirmed events; any agreements still expected to emerge from subsequent meetings should not be described as signed on 20 October.

up agreements translate into maritime training, investment or sectoral cooperation. Small-island climate concerns also offer a basis for sustained diplomatic dialogue.

REVISION POINTS

1. Mohamed Muizzu arrived in Islamabad on 20 October for a three-day state visit.
2. Shehbaz Sharif invited the Maldivian president.
3. Maritime security and climate change were among the scheduled discussion areas.

CSS ANGLE International Relations / Indian Ocean diplomacy **SOURCES** Radio Pakistan

04 / DEVELOPMENT / PARLIAMENT

National Assembly Hears Rs200 Billion Balochistan Allocation

The planning minister combined the development-budget figure with new education and skills commitments.

On Tuesday, 20 October, Minister for Planning and Development Ahsan Iqbal told the National Assembly that Rs200 billion had been allocated in the development budget for projects in Balochistan. He characterised it as the highest allocation for any province.

In the same parliamentary response, the minister announced an additional 5,000 scholarships for students from Balochistan and the tribal districts under a second phase of the relevant programme. He said the government also intended to launch solarisation work in the tribal districts and a digital-skills programme for young people.

The budget figure is a reported allocation, not proof that the entire amount had been released or spent. Similarly, the scholarships, solarisation and training initiatives were presented as commitments requiring administrative execution.

BACKGROUND

Development allocations are one part of Pakistan's federal-provincial political economy. Project selection, release schedules and implementation capability determine whether voted resources reach intended beneficiaries.

ANALYSIS

The distinction between allocation, disbursement and final delivery matters in evaluating policy. Education and digital-skills initiatives may improve opportunity, but their effectiveness depends on transparent selection and employment links.

REVISION POINTS

1. Ahsan Iqbal reported Rs200bn in development-budget projects for Balochistan.
2. He announced 5,000 additional scholarships for Balochistan and tribal districts.
3. Solarisation and digital-skills programmes were described as forthcoming initiatives.

CSS ANGLE Pakistan Affairs / regional inequality and development policy **SOURCES** Radio Pakistan

05 / BILATERAL SECURITY / GULF

Pakistan and Qatar Seek Closer Internal-Security Cooperation

The Doha meeting connected practical security cooperation with the region's wider political tensions.

On Tuesday, 20 October, Interior Minister Mohsin Naqvi met his

BACKGROUND

Qatari counterpart Sheikh Khalifa bin Hamad bin Khalifa Al Thani in Doha. The official Pakistan report said both sides agreed to strengthen cooperation and partnership in internal security.

The two ministers reviewed the regional situation and discussed ways to deepen bilateral engagement on internal-security issues. Naqvi said the two countries were working to promote regional peace and stability. The Qatari minister emphasised the value Doha attaches to its ties with Pakistan.

The public account did not specify a new security treaty, operational deployment, financing pledge or signed instrument. The development is therefore best understood as a ministerial political understanding, with any detailed implementation to be assessed when announced.

Gulf security issues affect Pakistan through trade, migration, regional diplomacy and energy links. Cooperation with an individual partner does not by itself define a new regional alignment.

ANALYSIS

Pakistan's engagement with Qatar adds another channel for consultation during a period of Middle Eastern tension. The useful measure will be concrete, lawful cooperation in information sharing, training and related institutions, rather than diplomatic wording alone.

REVISION POINTS

1. Mohsin Naqvi held the meeting in Doha on 20 October.
2. His counterpart was Sheikh Khalifa bin Hamad bin Khalifa Al Thani.
3. The official account concerned internal security and regional stability, not a signed treaty.

CSS ANGLE International Relations / Gulf diplomacy and security cooperation **SOURCES** Radio Pakistan

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02 World

Diplomacy, multilateral institutions, investment and climate

06 / GLOBAL ECONOMY / ASIA-PACIFIC

APEC Finance Ministers Open Hong Kong Talks Amid Global Strains

The two-day meeting linked macroeconomic resilience to digital infrastructure and household support.

On Tuesday, 20 October, the 2026 APEC Finance Ministers' Meeting began in Hong Kong, the first time the city hosted the gathering. Government and international-organisation representatives met to discuss the regional outlook, fiscal policy supporting households, digital-infrastructure finance and wider access to financial services.

China's finance minister Lan Fo'an urged member economies to strengthen macroeconomic policy dialogue and coordinate against negative spillovers. He called for digital and green transformation and cooperation on artificial intelligence. Hong Kong Financial Secretary Paul Chan urged investment in technology, skills and infrastructure while stressing the importance of open trade and stable financial rules.

APEC has 21 member economies. Its own outlook forecast regional growth of 3.2% in 2026, compared with 3.3% in 2025, and average inflation of 2.9%, compared with 2.4%. Those are forecasts from APEC, not final annual outcomes. The meeting was scheduled to continue on 21 October.

BACKGROUND

APEC is a cooperative forum rather than a supranational regulator. Its value lies in promoting compatible policies and facilitating trade, investment and technical cooperation among economies.

ANALYSIS

The meeting showed how energy shocks, technological concentration and fiscal constraints are being considered together. Policy coordination can lessen spillovers, but non-binding recommendations still depend on domestic governments and markets for effect.

REVISION POINTS

1. The finance ministers met in Hong Kong on 20–21 October 2026.
2. APEC comprises 21 member economies.
3. The APEC Policy Support Unit projected 3.2% regional growth in 2026.

CSS ANGLE Current Affairs / multilateral trade and economic coordination **SOURCES** Hong Kong Government · Reuters · APEC Secretariat

07 / INVESTMENT / INDUSTRIAL POLICY

Berlin Summit Draws More Than €225 Billion in Pledges

Germany's government used its investment summit to make the case for new industrial and digital capacity.

On Tuesday, 20 October, Germany held the Invest in Germany Summit in Berlin, where companies pledged more than €225 billion in investment commitments, according to the German Ministry for Economic Affairs and Energy as reported by Reuters. Chancellor Friedrich Merz used the gathering to emphasise private investment, faster approvals and modernisation.

Amazon said it planned more than €16 billion in investment during 2027 to

BACKGROUND

European governments face pressure to accelerate technology adoption, raise productivity and reduce regulatory delays. Industrial strategies increasingly combine infrastructure, skills and investment incentives.

expand cloud computing, artificial intelligence, satellite internet and media businesses in Germany. Brookfield outlined tens of billions of euros over five years across infrastructure and industry. Nvidia described commitments to European companies, including investment in four named German start-ups.

The summit was designed to connect executives with government leadership and encourage investment decisions. The headline total represents announced commitments from different companies over different time horizons. It should not be confused with funds already transferred, projects completed or realised foreign direct investment.

ANALYSIS

Commitments can signal interest, but their eventual economic value depends on project delivery, regulatory predictability and domestic supply capacity. Digital investment can strengthen industrial competitiveness, yet concentration in a few technologies adds implementation and market risk.

REVISION POINTS

1. The Berlin summit took place on 20 October 2026.
2. The investment commitments reported by Reuters exceeded €225bn.
3. Amazon described plans to invest more than €16bn in Germany during 2027.

CSS ANGLE International Relations / industrial policy and investment competition **SOURCES** Reuters · German Federal Government

08 / CLIMATE SCIENCE / DATA

Reuters Study Maps the Expansion of Extreme Heat Storms

A newly published historical analysis proposes a new label for heatwaves covering large parts of the globe.

On Tuesday, 20 October, Reuters published a data investigation based on hourly global temperature records dating back to 1960 and consultations with climate researchers. The project proposed the term “heat storm” for a heatwave that lasts at least five days and covers at least 1% of Earth’s surface at its largest extent.

Under Reuters’ operational definition, the investigators found roughly five active heat storms annually in the 1960s, against an average of about 102 per year during the 2020s. A prolonged event they named Vera lasted 367 days in 2023–24 and affected nearly 85% of Earth’s surface across its lifetime. The project also described overlapping or consecutive heat storms as “cascades.”

These designations are terminology adopted by the Reuters research project, not formal classifications established by the World Meteorological Organization. Its historical findings come from the project’s stated methodology and thresholds and should be read with that qualification.

BACKGROUND

A global mean temperature trend can conceal the regional reach, persistence and compounding health effects of extreme heat. Communicating spatial extent is one method for explaining climate risk.

ANALYSIS

The publication gives researchers and public institutions a proposed way to describe large-scale heat events. Planners should examine its threshold choices and independent validation before treating named heat storms as standard meteorological categories.

REVISION POINTS

1. The Reuters investigation was published on 20 October 2026.
2. Its heat-storm threshold combines at least five days with peak coverage of 1% of Earth.
3. Reuters estimated averages of about five annually in the 1960s and 102 in the 2020s.

CSS ANGLE Environmental Science / climate extremes and risk communication **SOURCES** Reuters Investigates · Reuters Investigates

09 / UN / SECURITY TECHNOLOGY

UN Research Institute Advances Forum on Military AI

Plans announced in New York focused on keeping human judgment central to security-sensitive applications.

On Tuesday, 20 October, the United Nations Institute for Disarmament Research outlined the next phase of its work on artificial intelligence in peace and security. UNIDIR director Robin Geiss told reporters that increasing military use of AI in early warning, reconnaissance and related systems raised questions about preserving meaningful human control.

The Institute's Centre of Excellence on AI, Peace and Security had been launched earlier in 2026. A further forum event was scheduled for 22 October in New York, organised with Switzerland and Pakistan. The event was to open expressions of interest for the centre's forum, which is intended to connect governments and other actors around governance and risk reduction.

UNIDIR also described work on responsible conduct for the defence-technology industry and risks of armed groups misusing AI. A planned forum and voluntary guidance are governance initiatives; they are not a binding global treaty or a prohibition on the military use of AI.

BACKGROUND

Advanced software has military applications ranging from surveillance and logistics to command support. Rules affecting deployment involve humanitarian law, verification and the allocation of responsibility for decisions.

ANALYSIS

The immediate challenge is bridging technical risk assessment with legal accountability. A multi-stakeholder forum can surface shared principles, while geopolitical rivalry and different national doctrines will complicate common standards.

REVISION POINTS

1. UNIDIR is the United Nations Institute for Disarmament Research.
2. Its AI, Peace and Security forum launch was scheduled for 22 October 2026.
3. The stated concerns included human control, reliable systems and industrial responsibility.

CSS ANGLE International Relations / arms control and technology governance **SOURCES** Associated Press · UNIDIR

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10 / DIPLOMACY / EUROPEAN SECURITY

Oslo Talks Seek Path Toward New Ukraine Negotiations

American, Ukrainian and European representatives discussed security guarantees and an approach to Russia.

On Tuesday, 20 October, Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskiy met US envoy Steve Witkoff in Oslo, with Norway, Finland and European and NATO representatives involved in the wider consultations. A US official described the discussions as constructive and said they covered a peace framework, security guarantees for Ukraine and a post-war economic plan.

The parties discussed ways to open direct negotiations involving Ukraine, Russia and the United States. Zelenskiy referred to security protections resembling NATO's collective-defence principle and said Ukrainian authorities were again receiving early warnings of Russian missile attacks. Norwegian Prime Minister Jonas Gahr Støre and Finnish President Alexander Stubb also commented positively on the diplomatic exchanges.

Reuters reported that Witkoff was expected to meet Russian President Vladimir Putin the next day. That proposed follow-up was not a completed meeting on 20 October. Differences over weapons supplies, satellite support, sanctions and attacks on energy infrastructure remained obstacles to a comprehensive settlement.

BACKGROUND

Any Ukraine settlement involves territorial questions, military security, reconstruction and the roles of the United States, Europe and Russia. A negotiation framework is separate from a ceasefire or a signed peace accord.

ANALYSIS

The useful diplomatic indicator is whether discussion produces enforceable security arrangements and direct talks involving the parties. Positive assessments by negotiators show momentum, but unresolved military and political disagreements remain substantial.

REVISION POINTS

1. Zelenskiy and Witkoff met in Oslo on 20 October 2026.
2. Security guarantees and a post-war economic plan were among topics reported by Reuters.
3. A possible Witkoff–Putin meeting was prospective, not an achievement of 20 October.

CSS ANGLE International Relations / negotiation, alliances and war termination **SOURCES** Reuters

Next Seven Days

22 OCT	**UNIDIR forum launch —** Expressions of interest for the AI, Peace and Security forum open at the New York event. Source
23 OCT	**UNIDIR industry framework dialogue —** An event examines responsible industry conduct for military AI. Source
26 OCT	**Electromagnetic security dialogue —** UNIDIR lists its Innovations Dialogue on electromagnetic disruption and security. Source
27–28 OCT	**US monetary policy meeting —** The Federal Open Market Committee is scheduled to meet for two days. Source

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03 General Knowledge

Facts and institutional details linked to the day's reports

01 SCO The 20 October SCO Council of Heads of Government meeting took place in Dushanbe, Tajikistan. ↗

02 DIPLOMACY Ishaq Dar attended as Pakistan's deputy prime minister and foreign minister. ↗

03 ECONOMY An SCO Development Bank was proposed for faster progress; it was not announced as operational. ↗

04 IMF Jihad Azour directed the IMF Middle East and Central Asia Department at the Islamabad meeting. ↗

05 IMF Pakistan's engagement referred to both the EFF and RSF facilities. ↗

06 MARKETS KSE-100 closed at 165,151.64 on 20 October 2026. ↗

07 MARKETS The KSE-100's day-on-day change on 20 October was −814.44 points (−0.49%). ↗

08 MONETARY The SBP policy rate was 11.50%, as last decided on 14 September 2026. ↗

09 PARLIAMENT Ahsan Iqbal reported Rs200bn allocated to Balochistan development projects. ↗

10 EDUCATION The planning minister announced 5,000 additional scholarships for Balochistan and tribal districts. ↗

11 MALDIVES President Mohamed Muizzu began a three-day Pakistan state visit on 20 October. ↗

12 GULF Mohsin Naqvi met Qatari Interior Minister Sheikh Khalifa bin Hamad bin Khalifa Al Thani. ↗

13 APEC APEC has 21 member economies; the 2026 finance-ministers meeting was held in Hong Kong. ↗

14 APEC APEC projected regional GDP growth of 3.2% for 2026. ↗

15 GERMANY Reuters reported investment commitments exceeding €225bn at the Berlin summit. ↗

16 CLIMATE Reuters defined its research category heat storm using five days and 1% peak global-area coverage. ↗

17 CLIMATE In Reuters' reconstruction, the 2020s averaged about 102 active heat storms a year. ↗

18 UN UNIDIR's AI, Peace and Security forum event was scheduled for 22 October 2026. ↗

19 UKRAINE Zelenskiy met US envoy Steve Witkoff in Oslo on 20 October 2026. ↗

20 EUROPE The October Oslo discussions covered security guarantees and a post-war economic plan. ↗

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04 Five Terms

A concise reference lexicon

01 / CONSTITUTION & POLITICAL SCIENCE

Electoral College

An electoral college is a body of selected electors that formally chooses an officeholder rather than having the office filled directly by the national popular vote. In the United States, the constitutional mechanism assigns electors to states and governs their presidential ballots.

WHY IT MATTERS It is useful in comparative constitutional design and debates about electoral legitimacy.

EXAMPLE The US Twelfth Amendment requires separate electoral ballots for president and vice-president; the rule operated in the presidential election of 1804.

SOURCE US National Archives, Electoral College legal provisions

02 / INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS & DIPLOMACY

Exequatur

An exequatur is the receiving state's formal authorisation for the head of a consular post to perform consular functions. Article 12 of the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations uses that term and allows the receiving state to refuse it without giving reasons.

WHY IT MATTERS It distinguishes consular accreditation from diplomatic rhetoric and clarifies host-state consent.

EXAMPLE The 1963 Vienna Convention, in force from 19 March 1967, codified exequatur in Article 12.

SOURCE United Nations, Vienna Convention on Consular Relations, art. 12

03 / ECONOMY & PUBLIC FINANCE

Automatic Stabiliser

An automatic stabiliser is a tax or spending mechanism that adjusts with the business cycle without a new discretionary policy decision. Falling taxable income can reduce tax receipts during a downturn, while eligible social transfers may increase.

WHY IT MATTERS It helps evaluate fiscal policy speed, countercyclical design and limits of discretionary stimulus.

EXAMPLE During the 2007–09 global financial crisis, tax and social-spending responses provided automatic support, as explained by the IMF.

SOURCE IMF, Fiscal Policy: Taking and Giving Away

04 / LAW, GOVERNANCE & ADMINISTRATION

Ultra Vires

Ultra vires describes an act performed outside the legal authority granted to a public body or official. A court may treat action as ultra vires when the decision-maker exceeds statutory powers or disregards limits on their use.

WHY IT MATTERS The term is central to administrative-law challenges and accountability for delegated power.

EXAMPLE The House of Commons Library's 2006 judicial-review guide cited the UK GCHQ case, reported in [1985] AC 374, in discussing legal limits on decision-makers.

SOURCE House of Commons Library, Judicial Review, 2006

05 / ENVIRONMENT & SCIENCE

El Niño–Southern Oscillation (ENSO)

ENSO is an irregular coupled variation in tropical Pacific ocean temperatures and atmospheric circulation. Its El Niño and La Niña phases can alter rainfall, temperature and circulation patterns far beyond the Pacific basin.

WHY IT MATTERS ENSO is important to climate forecasting, agricultural risk and disaster preparedness.

EXAMPLE NOAA recorded a very strong 1997–98 El Niño episode, with persistent warm conditions in the tropical Pacific.

SOURCE NOAA, El Niño overview

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05 Practice

15 multiple-choice questions · choose the single most defensible answer

01. In which city did the SCO Council of Heads of Government meet on 20 October 2026?

A. Tashkent
B. Bishkek
C. Dushanbe
D. Astana

02. Which institutional idea did Pakistan urge SCO members to advance?

A. An SCO Development Bank
B. An SCO common parliament
C. An SCO customs union
D. An SCO single central bank

03. Which IMF official met President Zardari in Islamabad on 20 October?

A. Kristalina Georgieva
B. Jihad Azour
C. Pierre-Olivier Gourinchas
D. David Malpass

04. Which date was associated with the KP emergency proclamation discussed in the Senate?

A. 7 October
B. 9 October
C. 13 October
D. 11 October

05. Which Maldivian president arrived for a state visit on 20 October?

A. Ibrahim Mohamed Solih
B. Abdulla Yameen
C. Mohamed Muizzu
D. Mohamed Nasheed

06. What Balochistan development allocation was cited in the National Assembly?

A. Rs150 billion
B. Rs200 billion
C. Rs250 billion
D. Rs300 billion

07. Pakistan's interior minister met his Qatari counterpart in which city?

A. Muscat
B. Manama
C. Kuwait City
D. Doha

08. How many member economies participate in APEC?

A. 21
B. 15
C. 27
D. 32

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09. What did APEC's Policy Support Unit forecast for regional growth in 2026?

A. 2.6%
B. 3.2%
C. 4.1%
D. 5.0%

10. Which German city hosted the 20 October investment summit?

A. Hamburg
B. Munich
C. Berlin
D. Frankfurt

11. What lower bound on peak global area did the Reuters heat-storm study use?

A. 1%
B. 5%
C. 10%
D. 20%

12. Which agency planned a forum launch on AI, peace and security for 22 October?

A. UNICEF
B. UNCTAD
C. UNESCO
D. UNIDIR

13. Which US envoy met President Zelenskiy in Oslo on 20 October?

A. Marco Rubio
B. Steve Witkoff
C. Jared Kushner
D. Pete Hegseth

14. Under Article 12 of the 1963 Vienna Consular Convention, an exequatur is:

A. A consular authorisation
B. A diplomatic passport
C. An extradition order
D. A treaty reservation

15. Which of the following best illustrates an automatic fiscal stabiliser?

A. A new ad hoc budget law
B. A one-time tax amnesty
C. Falling tax receipts in a downturn
D. A negotiated foreign loan

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Answer Key

01 C The Council met in Dushanbe, Tajikistan. Source

02 A Dar advocated development-finance arrangements, including a proposed bank. Source

03 B The official account identified Jihad Azour as the IMF departmental director. Source

04 D The legal dispute concerned the proclamation of 11 October. Source

05 C The visitor was President Mohamed Muizzu. Source

06 B Ahsan Iqbal cited Rs200 billion allocated in the development budget. Source

07 D The ministerial security meeting took place in Doha. Source

08 A APEC is a forum of 21 member economies. Source

09 B The APEC calendar brief gave a 3.2% growth projection. Source

10 C The Invest in Germany summit took place in Berlin. Source

11 A The Reuters category required at least 1% of global area at peak. Source

12 D The launch was scheduled by the United Nations Institute for Disarmament Research. Source

13 B Steve Witkoff attended the Oslo discussions. Source

14 A An exequatur admits a head of consular post to their functions. Source

15 C Income-linked tax revenue declines with the business cycle without a new decision. Source

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